

Self-checks

Although testicular cancer is uncommon in young people, it's important for a person to get into the habit of examining their testicles once a month from the age of about 15. This is to check that they're healthy. It's easy to do, and takes just a few minutes. The best time to examine the testicles is after a shower or bath, as the warm water relaxes the scrotum, making it easier to feel inside.

ALERT!

Seeking advice

If you feel any lumps, pain, or swelling in your testicles, it's essential to get them checked out by a doctor. In the majority of cases, there should be nothing to worry about, but it's always worth visiting a doctor to be sure.



1. The testicles

Gently roll each testicle between thumb and fingers. Apply a little pressure at times. Feel for any pain, lumps, or swelling.



2. The epididymis

Inspect the epididymis, the comma-shaped cord behind each testicle. It's important to learn what the epididymis feels like, as it can be mistaken for a lump or swelling.

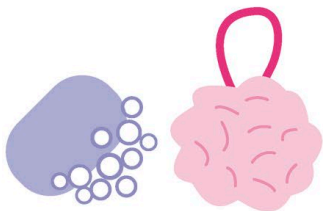


3. The vas deferens

The vas deferens feels like a firm, moveable, and smooth tube that runs behind each testicle. Try to run thumb and forefinger along its length, in both testicles, feeling for lumps or tenderness.

Looking after the testicles

In order to keep the testicles as healthy as possible, they should be cleaned regularly and protected against the risk of injury.



△ Cleaning thoroughly

Ensuring teens clean around and underneath the testicles helps to avoid body odor and infection.



△ Proper protection

It can be extremely painful to get hit in the testicles, so when playing any sport, it's a good idea to use a protective cup to decrease the risk of injury.

MYTH BUSTER

The truth about testicles

Bigger testicles don't make a person more "manly."

The size of a person's testicles do not make him more or less of a man. Everyone's body is different.

You won't get cancer if you're hit in the testicles.

Generally, people recover from being hit within an hour, though they may experience nausea.

Tight shorts may affect fertility.

Wearing tight clothing for long periods may increase the scrotum's temperature and slightly reduce sperm production.